

A Veritable Smörgåsbord

Google is useful, Google is fun. Google is good for everyone. That's our collective sentiment after having written this little book. You'd be hard pressed to find someone who hasn't ever "Googled" the Web, but as you know very well—or will soon learn—search is just the highlight of Google's many services. Ranging from advertising to exploring the surface of the earth, from creating a set of items from a list to delivering the latest news, Google is, has, and does it all.

So much of what Google provides is free, it's delightful. We hope here to alert you to the fact that there is such a thing as Google Code Search; that Google Answers might just be hosting the answer to something you're asking and search engines aren't helping; that you can create a Web page using Google tools and host it at Google, too.

Our purpose here is, therefore, essentially to wake you to the fact that Google is about much more than search, besides, of course, giving you brief guides on how to go about using all those services out there. A majority of Google's tools have been bundled with our *Digit Archive* CD this issue.

The company is ever expanding its portfolio of offerings, and by this time next year, you can expect a few more to have been added. In addition, some of the services change in functionality and manner of usage. (That's probably why Google tends to call all its services "Beta.") As a result, take this book as a snapshot of some of what Google offers right now. Since space doesn't permit a complete coverage, we'll be exploring more Google stuff next month.

As a little exercise, Google "Google is evil." Then look at the affirmations. Then, don't believe any of it. The current king of the Internet is one of the best things to have happened to it—if not the best.

Credits

The People Behind This Book

EDITORIAL

Deepak Ajwani Editor

Robert Sovereign-Smith Copy Editor

Ram Mohan Rao Writer, Copy Editor

Nimish Chandiramani Copy Editor

Abey John Writer

Arun Bisht Writer

DESIGN AND LAYOUT

Shivshankar Pillai, Vijay Padaya Layout Designers

Sivalal S Layout and Cover Design

Harsho Mohan Chatteraj Illustrator

© Jasubhai Digital Media

Published by Maulik Jasubhai on behalf of Jasubhai Digital Media.

No part of this book may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means without the prior written permission of the publisher.

December 2006

Free with Digit. Not to be sold separately. If you have paid separately for this book, please e-mail the editor at editor@thinkdigit.com along with details of location of purchase, for appropriate action.